

Classic Chocolate Pudding

2 bars (2 oz. each) unsweetened baking chocolate, broken
2 ½ cups mil, divided
1 cup sugar
¼ cup sugar
½ teaspoon salt
3 egg yolks, slightly beaten
1 tablespoon butter (do not use margarine)
1 teaspoon vanilla extract

Combine chocolate and 1 ½ cups milk in medium saucepan; cook over low heat stirring constantly with whisk, until chocolate is melted and mixture is smooth.

Stir together sugar, cornstarch and salt in medium bowl; blend in remaining 1 cup milk and egg yolks. Gradually stir into chocolate mixture. Cook over medium heat, stirring constantly, until mixture comes to a boil. Boil 1 minute, stirring constantly.

Remove from heat; add butter and vanilla. Enjoy either hot or cold. If cooling, pour into bowl; press plastic wrap directly onto surface. Refrigerate 2 to 3 hours or until cold. Just before serving, garnish with sweetened whipped cream and pecans if desired.